



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint Andrew Catholic School

School Website: <https://standrewsch.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Saint Andrew Catholic School (Fort Worth, TX 76109) presents a compelling case as a CLASSICAL Catholic school embedded in a deeply spiritual, formation-first mission. The website and school materials emphasize a Christ-centered community, partnership with families, a strong Catholic identity, and a curriculum transformation toward Catholic classical education, including partnerships with the University of Dallas for a Catholic classical approach and explicit reference to Great Books, Latin instruction, and classical pedagogy such as Socratic seminars in the upper grades. This combination yields a robust alignment with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education, with particular strength in religious foundations, formation-oriented purpose, pedagogy that includes Socratic inquiry and memory work, and a strong sense of faculty as living mentors within a living curriculum. Some aspects of curricular implementation (notably the Early Childhood Montessori track) introduce non-classical elements at the K–8 level, creating a partial deviation that places this school in the Somewhat Classical spectrum for Curriculum, while other categories remain strongly Classical.

Overall, the school's six-category assessment places Saint Andrew Catholic School predominantly in CLASSICAL territory, with Curriculum being the modest exception that drags the aggregate slightly toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in that category alone. The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence of a robust Catholic, liturgical, and theologically integrated approach (Mass, Adoration, catechesis, virtue formation) is explicit on the site, including the Catechesis of the Good Shepherd and Virtues in Practice programs, and a theology-forward, sacramental worldview. Positive keywords related to truth, goodness, beauty, liturgy, theology, and sacramental life are evident; no explicit negative signals are apparent. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: High presence of positive religious/metaphysical terms (truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, Mass, catechesis, sacraments, liturgical life, wonder). Negative indicators (relativism, secularism) are not present. Why this rating: The school situates itself squarely within a Catholic, theologically grounded, liturgical and communal spiritual formation framework.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** Evidence includes mission statements that frame education as formation toward virtue, wisdom, and faith; explicit references to forming virtuous leaders and a Christian, theocentric anthropology; emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable; and a sense of human excellence cultivated through classical formation and service. The diocesan and UD-related language reinforces a classical telos and the primacy of virtue over mere job preparation. Positive keywords: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, classical mission, scholé/rest, great conversation, human excellence, moral imagination, soul craft. Negative keywords: absence of “workforce preparation” language in favor of formation and virtue. Why this rating: The school's stated aims align with classical purposes and teleology centered on virtue and wisdom.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence shows a serious classical orientation (UD Catholic Classical curriculum, Latin in K–5, Great Books-tinged lists, emphasis on history across disciplines, and primary sources), but the Early Childhood program includes Montessori tracks alongside traditional approaches, indicating a blended model rather than a pure classical curriculum from PK–12. This dual track reduces the purity of classical curriculum across the entire program. Pos-

itive keywords: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), great books, primary sources, classics, Latin, historical breadth, Western civilization, reading lists, classical literature, rhetoric, memory work, narration, recitation. Negative keywords: Montessori track in Early Childhood; social studies terminology replacement concerns are not explicit in this site, but the Montessori presence is a divergence from standard classical curricula in early years. Why this rating: Strong classical elements exist, particularly in upper grades and in the UD curriculum, but the Montessori option in Early Childhood represents a non-classical component, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for Curriculum.

- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods** — CLASSICAL Evidence includes explicit use of Socratic or seminary-style discussion in the middle/high school, memory-based recitation and narration practices, and a clear emphasis on contemplation, scholé, and rhetoric. There are sections describing that upper grades use Socratic discussion and that students are trained in rhetoric with opportunities for public speaking. The lower grades also incorporate singing, chanting, and memory methods in line with classical pedagogy. Positive keywords: Socratic seminar, questioning, dialectic, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé, contemplation, wonder, seminar, rhetoric, oratory, debate, household formation integration. Negative signals: none identified in the site specifically pointing away from classical pedagogy. Why this rating: Pedagogy embodies core classical practices (Socratic inquiry, memory work, rhetoric training) across appropriate grade levels.
- **Element 5: Faculty** — CLASSICAL Evidence shows a faculty described as professionals who model virtue and knowledge, a living curriculum, and a collegial culture; the site emphasizes a strong faculty with degreed teachers and a mission-driven, mentorship-oriented approach. There are explicit references to faculty as exemplars and to a living curriculum integrated into school life. Positive keywords: living curriculum, mentors, masters, teachers as exemplars, portrait of teacher, collegial culture, vocation/formation, degreed teachers, Catholic formation. Negative signals: none evident. Why this rating: The site repeatedly highlights faculty as central to formation and excellence, aligning with classical expectations.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community** — CLASSICAL Evidence includes explicit partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, parent formation opportunities, open campus, and frequent family involvement in liturgical life and school activities. The site also references family-centered events, book/spiritual formation activities, and a welcoming approach to parent visits and involvement. Positive keywords: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, book clubs, seminars, open campus, hospitality, family liturgy, household worship, parent covenant. Negative signals: minimal. The site emphasizes active parental involvement rather than consumerist positioning. Why this rating: There is clear alignment with the classical model's emphasis on parental partnership and family-integrated formation.

Aggregate Assessment: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates a predominantly CLASSICAL orientation across five categories (Religious Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community) with Curriculum showing a strong but not pure classical alignment due to Montessori elements in Early Childhood.

What Would Move the Needle

- If Curriculum were to reach a fully classical, PK–12 consistency (eliminate Montessori in Early Childhood or clearly integrate it within a unified classical framework), the school would achieve a stronger, seamless classical curriculum footprint from PK–12.
- Increase breadth and depth of Great Books exposure and explicitly codify a K–12 Great Books sequence aligned to the UD Catholic Classical program, including more explicit “read alouds” and primary-source engagement across all grade bands.
- Expand the lower grades’ engagement with classical pedagogy (memory work, recitation, and narrative forms) to a fuller K–8 continuity, ensuring that memory and structured recitation are consistent and integrated with Socratic inquiry as students advance.
- Strengthen explicit public articulation of a long-term, formal teacher formation program modeled on a classical educator profile (portrait of a classical teacher) with ongoing professional development in

classical pedagogy.

- Broaden parent education offerings (e.g., regular classical education book studies and lectures) and formalize home/household liturgy alignment to deepen the parents' role as co-teachers.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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